

Truck Booking & Tracking System

Project Documentation

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Objective

To develop a GIS-enabled web application that allows users to **hire nearby heavy vehicles** (trucks and other freight vehicles) and **track their movement** from pickup to destination in real time.

The system simulates truck movement on a map, manages bookings via REST APIs (user and driver panels), stores vehicle and booking data in a JSON file, and lays the foundation for future **cost and profit optimization** for both users and vehicle owners.

Documented Algorithm with Flowchart

Steps in the Algorithm

1. Initialize Project & Load Configuration

- Start the Flask backend and load configuration (port, data file paths).
- Read initial data from backend/database/data.json including vehicles, locations, and existing bookings.
- Start background scheduler / simulator support modules.

2. User Booking Workflow

- User opens the **User Panel** (frontend) and views the map and list of predefined locations.
- User selects **pickup** and **drop** locations and enters cargo details if required.
- Frontend sends a POST request to the User API (/api/user/book) with pickup and drop coordinates.

3. Booking Creation & Vehicle Allocation

- Backend validates the request (locations present, coordinates valid).
- System searches the list of trucks in data.json to find the **nearest available vehicle** based on geographic distance from the pickup point.
- A new **Booking** object is created with status PENDING or ASSIGNED, and the selected truck is linked to this booking.
- Booking entry is stored in memory and persisted back to data.json.

4. Driver Notification & Acceptance

- The **Driver Panel** fetches bookings via Driver API endpoints (/api/driver/bookings).
- Driver views the list of active bookings and clicks **Accept** for one booking.
- Backend updates booking status to ACCEPTED, updates truck status to ON_TRIP, and triggers the **simulation** for that booking.

5. Trip Simulation – Phase 1: Move to Pickup

- The **Simulator Service** starts a background loop for the selected booking.
- It interpolates coordinates from the truck's current position to the pickup location and updates the truck position every fixed time step (e.g., 0.8 seconds).
- At the end of this phase, booking status becomes ARRIVED_DRIVER.
- After a small wait (or explicit driver action like "Mark Loaded"), booking status changes to LOADED.

6. Trip Simulation – Phase 2: Move to Drop

- Simulator computes a path from **pickup** to **drop** (in the prototype, a straight-line interpolation between coordinates).
- The truck's coordinates are updated periodically towards the drop location.
- During this phase, the map in the Tracking View and Driver/User Panels continuously polls the backend to fetch updated coordinates and statuses.

7. Completion & Cleanup

- When the drop location is reached, simulator sets booking status to COMPLETED.
- Truck status is reverted back to AVAILABLE.
- All updates are written to data.json.
- The system is ready to accept the next booking.

Textual Flowchart

(Use this as your **flowchart content** in the report/PPT – similar style to the emergency sample.)

START / Initialize

|
v

Load Configuration & Data

- Start Flask server
- Load vehicles, locations, bookings from data.json

|
v

User Creates Booking

- User selects pickup & drop on map
- Send POST /api/user/book with coordinates

|
v

Validate & Find Nearest Truck

- Check request fields
- Search available trucks
- Compute distance to pickup
- Choose nearest available truck

|
v

Create Booking & Assign Truck

- Create Booking object with status PENDING/ASSIGNED
- Persist to data.json

|
v

Driver Views & Accepts Booking

- Driver Panel calls /api/driver/bookings
- Driver clicks **Accept**
- Booking status → ACCEPTED
- Truck status → ON_TRIP

|
v

Start Simulation Thread

- Simulator starts for this booking

|
v

Phase 1: Move to Pickup

- Interpolate coordinates
- Update truck position every Δt
- On arrival: status ARRIVED_DRIVER
- Wait / Mark Loaded → status LOADED

|
v

Phase 2: Move to Drop

- Interpolate coordinates to drop
- Periodically update position & status
- Frontend map polls for live updates

|
v

Trip Completed

- Status COMPLETED
- Truck status back to AVAILABLE
- Persist final state to data.json

|
v

END

Pseudo-code

The pseudo-code is written in the same descriptive style as the emergency navigator sample: START, FUNCTION, uppercase keywords, etc.

High-Level Control Flow

START

FUNCTION main():

 LOAD configuration (port, data_file_path)

 LOAD data from JSON (vehicles, locations, existing bookings)

 INITIALIZE Flask app and API routes

 START background scheduler for simulation support

RUN Flask server

END

Booking Creation & Matching

FUNCTION create_booking(pickup_location, drop_location, cargo_details):

 VALIDATE pickup_location and drop_location

 nearest_truck = find_nearest_available_truck(pickup_location)

 IF nearest_truck == NONE:

 RETURN error "No trucks available"

 ENDIF

 booking_id = GENERATE_UNIQUE_ID()

 booking = NEW Booking(

 id = booking_id,

 pickup = pickup_location,

 drop = drop_location,

 truck_id = nearest_truck.id,

 cargo = cargo_details,

 status = "ASSIGNED"

)

 UPDATE nearest_truck.status = "ON_TRIP"

 SAVE booking and truck to data store (JSON)

 RETURN booking

END

FUNCTION find_nearest_available_truck(pickup_location):

```
best_truck = NONE
```

```
best_distance = INFINITY
```

```
FOR each truck IN trucks_list:
```

```
    IF truck.status == "AVAILABLE":
```

```
        d = distance(pickup_location, truck.current_location)
```

```
        IF d < best_distance:
```

```
            best_distance = d
```

```
            best_truck = truck
```

```
        ENDIF
```

```
    ENDIF
```

```
ENDFOR
```

```
RETURN best_truck
```

```
END
```

Driver Acceptance Flow

```
FUNCTION driver_accept_booking(booking_id, driver_id):
```

```
    booking = GET booking BY id
```

```
    IF booking == NONE:
```

```
        RETURN error "Booking not found"
```

```
    ENDIF
```

```
    truck = GET truck BY booking.truck_id
```

```
    IF truck == NONE:
```

```
        RETURN error "Truck not found"
```

```
    ENDIF
```

```
booking.status = "ACCEPTED"
```

```
booking.driver_id = driver_id
```

```
SAVE booking to data store
```

```
START simulate_booking(booking.id) IN background_thread
```

```
RETURN booking
```

```
END
```

Simulation Logic

This captures the core of backend/services/simulator.py.

```
FUNCTION simulate_booking(booking_id):
```

```
    booking = GET booking BY id
```

```
    truck = GET truck BY booking.truck_id
```

```
    IF booking == NONE OR truck == NONE:
```

```
        RETURN
```

```
    ENDIF
```

```
    '----- Phase 1: Move truck to pickup location -----'
```

```
    path_to_pickup = generate_route(truck.current_location, booking.pickup)
```

```
    FOR each point IN path_to_pickup:
```

```
        truck.current_location = point
```

```
        SAVE truck to data store
```

```
        SLEEP(0.8 seconds)
```


ENDFOR

booking.status = "ARRIVED_DRIVER"

SAVE booking

'Option A: automatic loading with delay'

SLEEP(3 seconds)

booking.status = "LOADED"

SAVE booking

'----- Phase 2: Move truck to drop location -----'

path_to_drop = generate_route(booking.pickup, booking.drop)

FOR each point IN path_to_drop:

truck.current_location = point

SAVE truck to data store

SLEEP(0.8 seconds)

ENDFOR

booking.status = "COMPLETED"

truck.status = "AVAILABLE"

SAVE booking and truck

END

Routing & Cost Estimation (if cost_calculator/route_optimizer used)

FUNCTION generate_route(start_point, end_point):

'Prototype: simple straight-line interpolation'

```
steps = 20
```

```
route = EMPTY_LIST
```

```
FOR i FROM 0 TO steps:
```

```
    t = i / steps
```

```
    lat = start_point.lat * (1 - t) + end_point.lat * t
```

```
    lon = start_point.lon * (1 - t) + end_point.lon * t
```

```
    APPEND (lat, lon) TO route
```

```
ENDFOR
```

```
RETURN route
```

```
END
```

```
FUNCTION estimate_trip_cost(distance_km, base_rate_per_km, cargo_weight):
```

```
    variable_cost = distance_km * base_rate_per_km
```

```
    weight_factor = 1.0
```

```
    IF cargo_weight > THRESHOLD:
```

```
        weight_factor = 1.2
```

```
    ENDIF
```

```
    total_cost = variable_cost * weight_factor
```

```
    RETURN total_cost
```

```
END
```

API Handler Pseudo-code

```
ROUTE POST /api/user/book:
```

```
    READ pickup_location, drop_location, cargo_details FROM request
```

```
    booking = create_booking(pickup_location, drop_location, cargo_details)
```

RETURN booking AS JSON

ROUTE GET /api/driver/bookings:

bookings = GET all bookings WHERE status IN ("ASSIGNED", "ACCEPTED",
"ARRIVED_DRIVER", "LOADED")

RETURN bookings AS JSON

ROUTE POST /api/driver/accept/<booking_id>:

driver_id = GET from request or session

booking = driver_accept_booking(booking_id, driver_id)

RETURN booking AS JSON

ROUTE GET /api/truck/<booking_id>:

booking = GET booking BY id

truck = GET truck BY booking.truck_id

RETURN booking + truck.current_location AS JSON

Data Structures

Based on backend/models/booking.py, backend/models/vehicle.py, and the JSON layout used by the app.

Vehicles (Dynamic Data)

Represents all heavy vehicles tracked by the system.

Vehicle:

id: STRING 'Unique truck ID'

name: STRING 'Truck or fleet name'

current_location:

lat: FLOAT

lon: FLOAT

status: STRING 'AVAILABLE | ON_TRIP | UNAVAILABLE'

capacity_kg: FLOAT 'Cargo capacity (optional)'

base_rate_per_km: FLOAT 'Base fare rate'

Example JSON entry:

```
{  
  "id": "TRUCK-001",  
  "name": "IITB-Logistics-1",  
  "current_location": { "lat": 19.1334, "lon": 72.9133 },  
  "status": "AVAILABLE",  
  "capacity_kg": 8000,  
  "base_rate_per_km": 20.0  
}
```

Bookings (Dynamic Data)

Each user request mapped to a specific truck and route.

Booking:

id: STRING 'Unique booking ID'

user_name: STRING (optional)

pickup:

lat: FLOAT

lon: FLOAT

label: STRING

drop:

lat: FLOAT

lon: FLOAT

label: STRING

truck_id: STRING 'Assigned Vehicle.id'

driver_id: STRING (optional)

cargo_weight_kg: FLOAT (optional)
distance_km: FLOAT (estimated)
estimated_cost: FLOAT
status: STRING 'PENDING | ASSIGNED | ACCEPTED |
ARRIVED_DRIVER | LOADED | COMPLETED'
created_at: DATETIME

Example:

```
{  
  "id": "BOOK-123",  
  "pickup": { "lat": 19.1310, "lon": 72.9140, "label": "Main Gate" },  
  "drop": { "lat": 19.1180, "lon": 72.9090, "label": "Warehouse" },  
  "truck_id": "TRUCK-001",  
  "distance_km": 7.5,  
  "estimated_cost": 150.0,  
  "status": "ASSIGNED",  
  "created_at": "2025-11-23T10:10:00Z"  
}
```

Locations (Static / Semi-Static Data)

Predefined campus / city locations for easier user selection.

Location:

name: STRING
lat: FLOAT
lon: FLOAT

Example:

```
{  
  "name": "IIT Bombay Main Gate",  
  "lat": 19.1334,  
  "lon": 72.9133
```

```
}
```

Stored in a list inside data.json.

Simulator State (Internal Data Structure)

Used by the simulation service to track progress of each booking.

SimulationState:

```
booking_id: STRING
phase: STRING    'TO_PICKUP | TO_DROP | DONE'
current_step: INT
total_steps: INT
last_update_time: DATETIME
```

Application Deployment

(Parallel section to “Application Deployment” in the emergency doc.)

1. Clone Repository

- Clone the GitHub repository containing backend and frontend code.

2. Install Backend Dependencies

- Ensure Python 3 is installed.
- Install required packages: Flask, flask-cors, python-dotenv, requests.

3. pip install -r requirements.txt

4. Run the Flask Backend

5. cd backend

6. python app.py

- The server runs at a configured port (e.g., http://127.0.0.1:8000).

7. Access Frontend Panels

- **User Panel** – for booking trucks and viewing assigned trip.
- **Driver Panel** – for drivers to view bookings and accept them.
- **Map View / Tracking Page** – to visualize real-time truck movement.

8. Data Persistence

- All vehicles, locations, and booking updates are stored in backend/database/data.json.
- This file acts as a lightweight database for demonstration and testing.

Sample API Payloads (Analogue of “Sample Query / Sample Data”)

Sample User Booking Request

POST /api/user/book

Content-Type: application/json

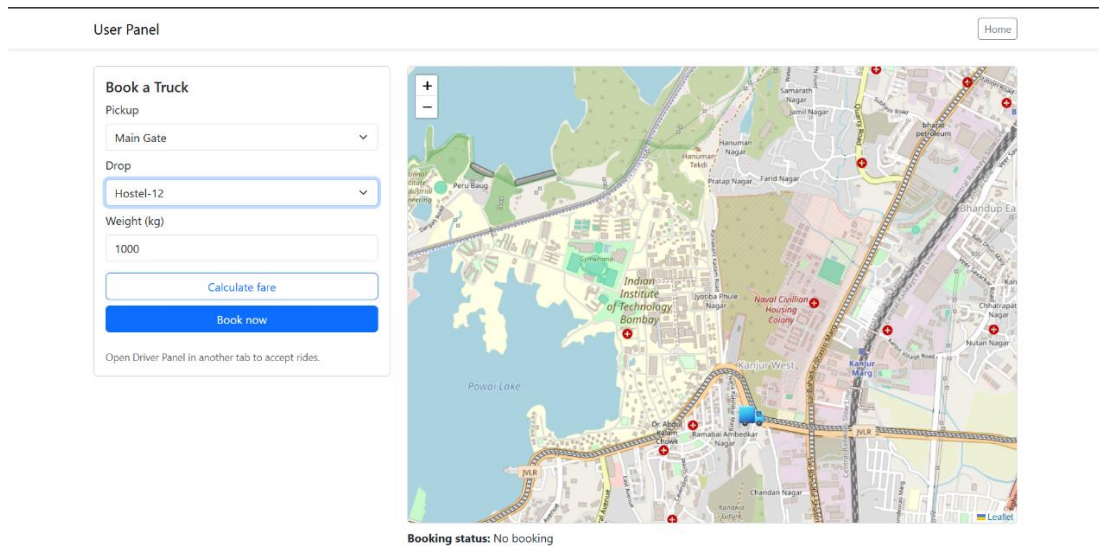
```
{  
  "pickup": { "lat": 19.1334, "lon": 72.9133, "label": "IITB Main Gate" },  
  "drop": { "lat": 19.1180, "lon": 72.9090, "label": "Logistics Hub" },  
  "cargo_weight_kg": 5000  
}
```

Sample Tracking Response

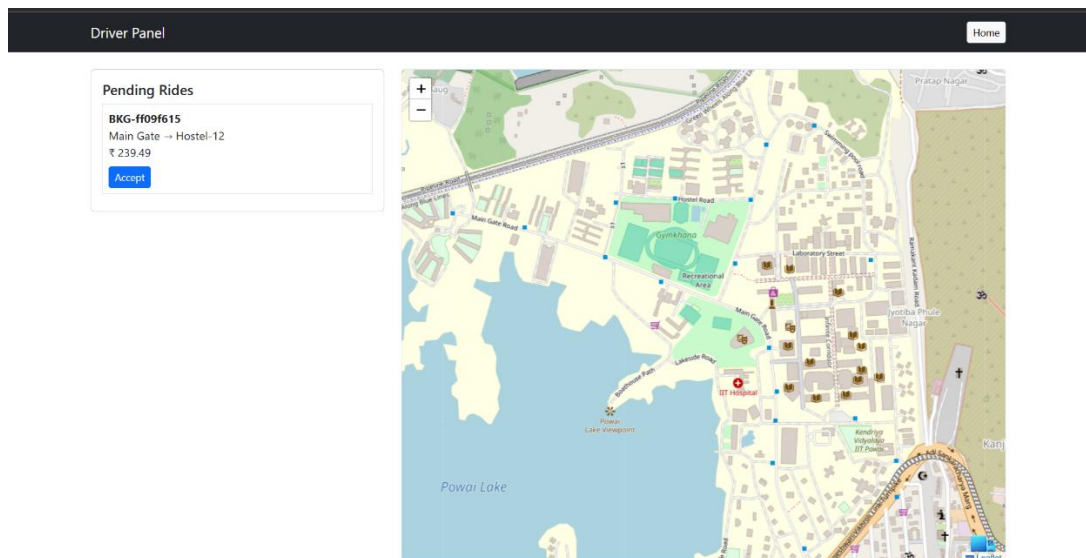
```
{  
  "booking": {  
    "id": "BOOK-123",  
    "status": "ON_ROUTE_TO_DROP",  
    "pickup": { "lat": 19.1334, "lon": 72.9133 },  
    "drop": { "lat": 19.1180, "lon": 72.9090 }  
  },  
  "truck": {  
    "id": "TRUCK-001",  
    "current_location": { "lat": 19.1260, "lon": 72.9112 },  
    "status": "ON_TRIP"  
  }  
}
```

Snapshots

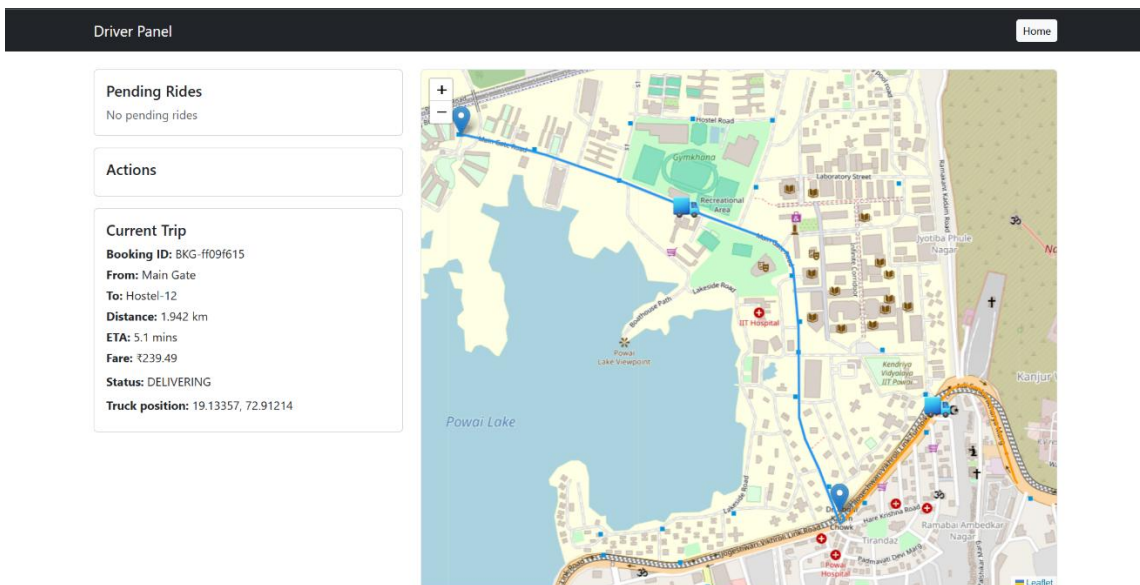
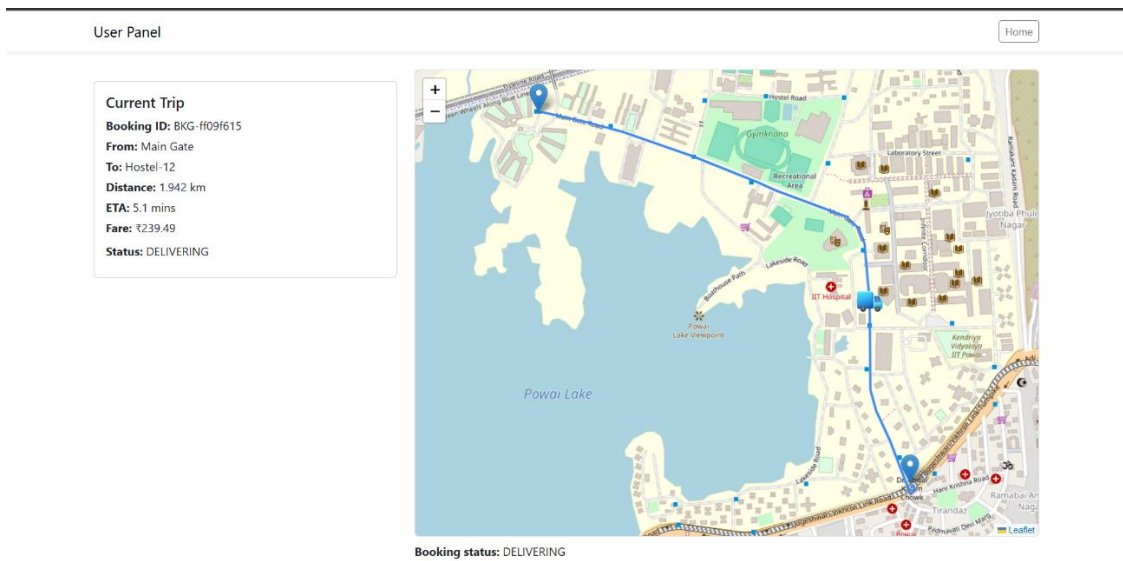
- **Figure 1: Truck Booking User Panel**
– Screenshot showing map, pickup/drop selection, and booking form.



- **Figure 2: Driver Panel – Pending & Accepted Bookings**
– Screenshot showing booking list with Accept buttons.



- **Figure 3: Trip Tracking View**
– Screenshot of truck moving along the route with status.



Book a Truck

Pickup

Main Gate

Drop

Hostel-12

Weight (kg)

1000

Distance: 1.942 km | ETA: 5.1 mins | Cost: ₹239.49

Calculate fare

Book now

Trip delivered successfully.

Open Driver Panel in another tab to accept rides.



Booking status: COMPLETED